

Ἀριστείδης Κοϊντιλιανός

Aristides the Music Theorist on Music Theory in Late Antiquity

eul_aid: suc

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)
Dialect: Κοινή τεχνική [Technical Koine](#)
Domain: Ἐπιστήμη [Science](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)

Aristides the Music Theorist was a late antique Greek author active in the late third or early fourth century CE. The epithet "Quintilianus" suggests a possible connection to the Roman rhetorician Quintilian, though this remains unconfirmed. He is known only for his work on music theory and is distinguished from the second-century orator Aelius Aristides.

His sole surviving work is the comprehensive treatise **On Music**, which exists complete in three books. This treatise is a vital source for late Roman harmonic theory, musical ethics, and the pedagogical and cosmological role of music. It synthesizes Pythagorean and Aristoxenian harmonics with Platonic and Neoplatonic philosophy, systematically detailing scales, intervals, and rhythms while emphasizing music's moral and psychological effects. **On Music** is a key document for understanding the philosophical foundations of ancient music theory.

Works (1)

- [Περὶ Μουσικῆς](#) · [On Music](#) · 103 passages